

20261006 Quiz

for (MATH230) Probability & Statistics

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Exercise 4.34. Let X be a random variable with the following probability distribution:

x	-2	3	5
$f(x)$	0.3	0.3	0.4

Find the standard deviation of X .

Solution. By Theorem 4.2,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[X] &= (-2)(0.3) + (3)(0.3) + (5)(0.4) = \frac{23}{10}, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= (-2)^2(0.3) + 3^2(0.3) + 5^2(0.4) = \frac{139}{10}.\end{aligned}$$

Hence,

$$\text{Var}(X) = \frac{139}{10} - \left(\frac{23}{10}\right)^2 = \frac{861}{100},$$

so

$$\sigma_X = \frac{\sqrt{861}}{10} \approx 2.93.$$

□

Exercise 4.35. The random variable X , representing the number of errors per 100 lines of software code, has the following probability distribution:

x	2	3	4	5	6
$f(x)$	0.01	0.25	0.4	0.3	0.04

Using Theorem 4.2 on page 141, find the variance of X .

Solution. Theorem 4.2 gives

$$\text{Var}(X) = \mathbb{E}[X^2] - \mathbb{E}[X]^2.$$

Here,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[X] &= (2)(0.01) + (3)(0.25) + (4)(0.4) + (5)(0.3) + (6)(0.04) = 4.11, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= 2^2(0.01) + 3^2(0.25) + 4^2(0.4) + 5^2(0.3) + 6^2(0.04) = 17.63.\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\text{Var}(X) = 17.63 - (4.11)^2 = 0.7379 \approx 0.74.$$

□

Exercise 4.36. Suppose that the probabilities are 0.4, 0.3, 0.2, and 0.1, respectively, that 0, 1, 2, or 3 power failures will strike a certain subdivision in any given year. Find the mean and variance of the random variable X representing the number of power failures striking this subdivision.

Solution. The distribution is

$$p_X(0) = 0.4, \quad p_X(1) = 0.3, \quad p_X(2) = 0.2, \quad p_X(3) = 0.1.$$

Thus,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[X] &= (1)(0.3) + (2)(0.2) + (3)(0.1) = 1, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= (1)^2(0.3) + (2)^2(0.2) + (3)^2(0.1) = 2.\end{aligned}$$

By Theorem 4.2,

$$\text{Var}(X) = 2 - 1^2 = 1.$$

Hence,

$$\boxed{\mu_X = 1, \quad \text{Var}(X) = 1}.$$

□

Exercise 4.37. A dealer's profit, in units of \$5000, on a new automobile is a random variable X having the density function given in Exercise 4.12 on page 137. Find the variance of X .

Solution. From Exercise 4.12,

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 2(1-x), & 0 < x < 1, \\ 0, & \text{elsewhere.} \end{cases}$$

Direct integration gives

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[X] &= \int_0^1 2x(1-x) \, dx = \frac{1}{3}, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= \int_0^1 2x^2(1-x) \, dx = \frac{1}{6}.\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\boxed{\text{Var}(X) = \frac{1}{6} - \left(\frac{1}{3}\right)^2 = \frac{1}{18}}.$$

□

Exercise 4.40. Referring to Exercise 4.14 on page 137, find $\sigma_{g(X)}^2$ for the function $g(X) = 3X + 4$.

Solution. From Exercise 4.14,

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{2(x+2)}{5}, & 0 < x < 1, \\ 0, & \text{elsewhere.} \end{cases}$$

Using Theorem 4.3,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[g(X)] &= \int_0^1 (3x+4) \frac{2(x+2)}{5} \, dx = \frac{28}{5}, \\ \mathbb{E}[g(X)^2] &= \int_0^1 (3x+4)^2 \frac{2(x+2)}{5} \, dx = \frac{321}{10}.\end{aligned}$$

Hence,

$$\boxed{\text{Var}(g(X)) = \frac{321}{10} - \left(\frac{28}{5}\right)^2 = \frac{37}{50} = 0.74}.$$

□

Exercise 4.41. Find the standard deviation of the random variable $h(X) = (3X + 1)^2$ in Exercise 4.17 on page 138.

Solution. From Exercise 4.17,

x	-3	6	9
$p_X(x)$	$\frac{1}{6}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{3}$

and

$$h(-3) = 64, \quad h(6) = 361, \quad h(9) = 784.$$

By Theorem 4.3,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[h(X)] &= 64 \left(\frac{1}{6}\right) + 361 \left(\frac{1}{2}\right) + 784 \left(\frac{1}{3}\right) = \frac{905}{2}, \\ \mathbb{E}[h(X)^2] &= 64^2 \left(\frac{1}{6}\right) + 361^2 \left(\frac{1}{2}\right) + 784^2 \left(\frac{1}{3}\right) = \frac{541457}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus,

$$\text{Var}(h(X)) = \frac{541457}{2} - \left(\frac{905}{2}\right)^2 = \frac{263889}{4},$$

and therefore

$$\sigma_{h(X)} = \frac{\sqrt{263889}}{2} \approx 256.85.$$

□

Exercise 4.43. The length of time, in minutes, for an airplane to obtain clearance for takeoff at a certain airport is a random variable $Y = 3X - 2$, where X has the density function

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{4}e^{-x/4}, & x > 0, \\ 0, & \text{elsewhere.} \end{cases}$$

Find the mean and variance of the random variable Y .

Solution. Applying the expectation formulas directly to $Y = 3X - 2$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[Y] &= \int_0^\infty (3x - 2) \frac{1}{4} e^{-x/4} dx = 10, \\ \mathbb{E}[Y^2] &= \int_0^\infty (3x - 2)^2 \frac{1}{4} e^{-x/4} dx = 244. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\text{Var}(Y) = 244 - 10^2 = 144,$$

so

$$\mu_Y = 10, \quad \text{Var}(Y) = 144.$$

□

Exercise 4.44. Find the covariance of the random variables X and Y of Exercise 3.39 on page 125.

Solution. In Exercise 3.39, four pieces are selected from 3 oranges, 2 apples, and 3 bananas, with X and Y denoting the numbers of oranges and apples selected. Hence

$$p_{X,Y}(x,y) = \frac{\binom{3}{x}\binom{2}{y}\binom{3}{4-x-y}}{\binom{8}{4}}$$

for the admissible values of x and y . Summing over this joint distribution gives

$$\mathbb{E}[X] = \frac{3}{2}, \quad \mathbb{E}[Y] = 1, \quad \mathbb{E}[XY] = \frac{9}{7}.$$

By Theorem 4.4,

$$\text{Cov}(X, Y) = \mathbb{E}[XY] - \mathbb{E}[X]\mathbb{E}[Y] = \frac{9}{7} - \frac{3}{2} = -\frac{3}{14}.$$

□

Exercise 4.45. Find the covariance of the random variables X and Y of Exercise 3.49 on page 126.

Solution. From the joint distribution in Exercise 3.49, the marginal distributions are

$$\begin{aligned} p_X(1) &= 0.10, & p_X(2) &= 0.35, & p_X(3) &= 0.55, \\ p_Y(1) &= 0.20, & p_Y(3) &= 0.50, & p_Y(5) &= 0.30. \end{aligned}$$

Thus,

$$\mathbb{E}[X] = \frac{49}{20}, \quad \mathbb{E}[Y] = \frac{16}{5},$$

and direct summation over the joint distribution gives

$$\mathbb{E}[XY] = \frac{157}{20}.$$

Therefore, by Theorem 4.4,

$$\text{Cov}(X, Y) = \frac{157}{20} - \left(\frac{49}{20}\right)\left(\frac{16}{5}\right) = \frac{1}{100} = 0.01.$$

□

Exercise 4.48. Given a random variable X , with standard deviation σ_X , and a random variable $Y = a + bX$, show that if $b < 0$, the correlation coefficient $\rho_{XY} = -1$, and if $b > 0$, $\rho_{XY} = 1$.

Solution. Assume $\sigma_X > 0$, as required for the correlation coefficient to be defined. Since

$$\mathbb{E}[Y] = a + b\mathbb{E}[X],$$

we have

$$Y - \mathbb{E}[Y] = b(X - \mathbb{E}[X]).$$

Hence, directly from the definitions,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Cov}(X, Y) &= b \text{Var}(X) = b\sigma_X^2, \\ \sigma_Y &= |b|\sigma_X. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\rho_{X,Y} = \frac{\text{Cov}(X, Y)}{\sigma_X \sigma_Y} = \frac{b}{|b|} = \begin{cases} -1, & b < 0, \\ 1, & b > 0. \end{cases}$$

□

Exercise 4.52. Random variables X and Y follow a joint distribution

$$f(x, y) = \begin{cases} 2, & 0 < x \leq y < 1, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Determine the correlation coefficient between X and Y .

Solution. Over the support $0 < x \leq y < 1$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[X] &= \int_0^1 \int_0^y 2x \, dx \, dy = \frac{1}{3}, & \mathbb{E}[Y] &= \int_0^1 \int_0^y 2y \, dx \, dy = \frac{2}{3}, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= \int_0^1 \int_0^y 2x^2 \, dx \, dy = \frac{1}{6}, & \mathbb{E}[Y^2] &= \int_0^1 \int_0^y 2y^2 \, dx \, dy = \frac{1}{2}, \\ \mathbb{E}[XY] &= \int_0^1 \int_0^y 2xy \, dx \, dy = \frac{1}{4}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus,

$$\text{Var}(X) = \text{Var}(Y) = \frac{1}{18}, \quad \text{Cov}(X, Y) = \frac{1}{4} - \left(\frac{1}{3}\right)\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) = \frac{1}{36}.$$

Therefore,

$$\rho_{X,Y} = \frac{1/36}{\sqrt{(1/18)(1/18)}} = \frac{1}{2}.$$

□

Exercise 4.57. Let X be a random variable with the following probability distribution:

x	-3	6	9
$f(x)$	$\frac{1}{6}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{2}$

Find $E(X)$ and $E(X^2)$ and then, using these values, evaluate $E[(2X + 1)^2]$.

Solution. Directly from the distribution,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[X] &= (-3)\left(\frac{1}{6}\right) + 6\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + 9\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = 6, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= 9\left(\frac{1}{6}\right) + 36\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + 81\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = 54. \end{aligned}$$

Since $(2X + 1)^2 = 4X^2 + 4X + 1$, Theorem 4.6 gives

$$\mathbb{E}[(2X + 1)^2] = 4\mathbb{E}[X^2] + 4\mathbb{E}[X] + 1 = 241.$$

□

Exercise 4.58. The total time, measured in units of 100 hours, that a teenager runs their hair dryer over a period of one year is a continuous random variable X that has the density function

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} x, & 0 < x < 1, \\ 2 - x, & 1 \leq x < 2, \\ 0, & \text{elsewhere.} \end{cases}$$

Use Theorem 4.6 to evaluate the mean of the random variable $Y = 60X^2 + 48X$, where Y is equal to the number of kilowatt hours expended annually.

Solution. First,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[X] &= \int_0^1 x^2 \, dx + \int_1^2 x(2-x) \, dx = 1, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= \int_0^1 x^3 \, dx + \int_1^2 x^2(2-x) \, dx = \frac{7}{6}.\end{aligned}$$

By Theorem 4.6,

$$\mathbb{E}[Y] = 60\mathbb{E}[X^2] + 48\mathbb{E}[X] = 60\left(\frac{7}{6}\right) + 48 = \boxed{118}.$$

Thus, the mean annual energy expenditure is 118 kilowatt hours. □

Exercise 4.60. Suppose that X and Y are independent random variables having the joint probability distribution

$f(x, y)$	x	
	2	4
y		
1	0.15	0.10
3	0.25	0.25
5	0.15	0.10

Find

- (a) $E(2X - 3Y)$;
- (b) $E(XY)$.

Solution. The marginal means are

$$\mathbb{E}[X] = (2)(0.55) + (4)(0.45) = \frac{29}{10}, \quad \mathbb{E}[Y] = (1)(0.25) + (3)(0.50) + (5)(0.25) = 3.$$

- (a) By Theorem 4.7,

$$\boxed{\mathbb{E}[2X - 3Y] = 2\mathbb{E}[X] - 3\mathbb{E}[Y] = -\frac{16}{5}}.$$

- (b) Using the displayed joint distribution directly,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[XY] &= \sum_x \sum_y xyf(x, y) \\ &= (2)(1)(0.15) + (4)(1)(0.10) + (2)(3)(0.25) + (4)(3)(0.25) \\ &\quad + (2)(5)(0.15) + (4)(5)(0.10) \\ &= \boxed{\frac{87}{10}}.\end{aligned}$$

□

Exercise 4.61. Use Theorem 4.7 to evaluate $E(2XY^2 - X^2Y)$ for the joint probability distribution shown in Table 3.1 on page 116.

Solution. By Theorem 4.7,

$$\mathbb{E}[2XY^2 - X^2Y] = 2\mathbb{E}[XY^2] - \mathbb{E}[X^2Y].$$

From Table 3.1, the only nonzero joint probability with both x and y positive is

$$p_{X,Y}(1, 1) = \frac{3}{14}.$$

Hence,

$$\mathbb{E}[XY^2] = \frac{3}{14}, \quad \mathbb{E}[X^2Y] = \frac{3}{14},$$

and therefore

$$\boxed{\mathbb{E}[2XY^2 - X^2Y] = \frac{3}{14}}.$$

□

Exercise 4.65. Let X represent the number that occurs when a red die is tossed and Y the number that occurs when a green die is tossed. Find

- (a) $E(2X + Y)$;
- (b) $E(X - 2Y)$;
- (c) $E(2XY)$.

Solution. For each die,

$$\mathbb{E}[X] = \mathbb{E}[Y] = \frac{1}{6} \sum_{k=1}^6 k = \frac{7}{2}.$$

Therefore, by Theorem 4.7,

$$(a) \quad \mathbb{E}[2X + Y] = 2\mathbb{E}[X] + \mathbb{E}[Y] = \boxed{\frac{21}{2}},$$

$$(b) \quad \mathbb{E}[X - 2Y] = \mathbb{E}[X] - 2\mathbb{E}[Y] = \boxed{-\frac{7}{2}}.$$

For part (c), the two die outcomes are independent, so their joint pmf is $1/36$ on $\{1, \dots, 6\}^2$. Thus

$$\mathbb{E}[XY] = \frac{1}{36} \left(\sum_{x=1}^6 x \right) \left(\sum_{y=1}^6 y \right) = \frac{49}{4},$$

$$(c) \quad \mathbb{E}[2XY] = \boxed{\frac{49}{2}}.$$

□

Exercise 4.69. Consider Review Exercise 3.77 on page 128. The random variables X and Y represent the number of vehicles that arrive at two separate street corners during a certain 2-minute period in the day. The joint distribution is

$$f(x, y) = \left(\frac{1}{4^{x+y}} \right) \left(\frac{9}{16} \right),$$

for $x = 0, 1, 2, \dots$ and $y = 0, 1, 2, \dots$

- (a) Give $E(X)$, $E(Y)$, $\text{Var}(X)$, and $\text{Var}(Y)$.
- (b) Consider $Z = X + Y$, the sum of the two. Find $E(Z)$ and $\text{Var}(Z)$.

Solution. The joint pmf factors as

$$f(x, y) = \left[\frac{3}{4} \left(\frac{1}{4} \right)^x \right] \left[\frac{3}{4} \left(\frac{1}{4} \right)^y \right].$$

Thus X and Y are independent and have the same marginal pmf. Using the standard power-series sums,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[X] &= \mathbb{E}[Y] = \frac{3}{4} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} k \left(\frac{1}{4}\right)^k = \frac{1}{3}, \\ \mathbb{E}[X^2] &= \mathbb{E}[Y^2] = \frac{3}{4} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} k^2 \left(\frac{1}{4}\right)^k = \frac{5}{9}.\end{aligned}$$

Hence,

$$\boxed{\mathbb{E}[X] = \mathbb{E}[Y] = \frac{1}{3}, \quad \text{Var}(X) = \text{Var}(Y) = \frac{4}{9}}.$$

For $Z = X + Y$,

$$\mathbb{E}[Z] = \mathbb{E}[X] + \mathbb{E}[Y] = \frac{2}{3}.$$

Also, the factorization of the joint pmf gives

$$\mathbb{E}[XY] = \mathbb{E}[X]\mathbb{E}[Y] = \frac{1}{9},$$

so

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[Z^2] &= \mathbb{E}[X^2] + 2\mathbb{E}[XY] + \mathbb{E}[Y^2] = \frac{4}{3}, \\ \text{Var}(Z) &= \frac{4}{3} - \left(\frac{2}{3}\right)^2 = \frac{8}{9}.\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\boxed{\mathbb{E}[Z] = \frac{2}{3}, \quad \text{Var}(Z) = \frac{8}{9}}.$$

□

Exercise 4.70. Consider Review Exercise 3.64 on page 127. There are two service lines. The random variables X and Y are the proportions of time that line 1 and line 2 are in use, respectively. The joint probability density function for (X, Y) is given by

$$f(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{3}{2}(x^2 + y^2), & 0 \leq x, y \leq 1, \\ 0, & \text{elsewhere.} \end{cases}$$

- Determine whether or not X and Y are independent.
- It is of interest to know something about the proportion of $Z = X + Y$, the sum of the two proportions. Find $E(X + Y)$. Also find $E(XY)$.
- Find $\text{Var}(X)$, $\text{Var}(Y)$, and $\text{Cov}(X, Y)$.
- Find $\text{Var}(X + Y)$.

Solution. (a) The marginal densities are

$$\begin{aligned}f_X(x) &= \int_0^1 \frac{3}{2}(x^2 + y^2) \, dy = \frac{1 + 3x^2}{2}, \\ f_Y(y) &= \int_0^1 \frac{3}{2}(x^2 + y^2) \, dx = \frac{1 + 3y^2}{2},\end{aligned}$$

for $0 \leq x, y \leq 1$. Since $f(x, y) \neq f_X(x)f_Y(y)$ in general,

$$\boxed{X \text{ and } Y \text{ are not independent.}}$$

(b) By symmetry,

$$\mathbb{E}[X] = \mathbb{E}[Y] = \int_0^1 x \frac{1+3x^2}{2} dx = \frac{5}{8}.$$

Hence,

$$\boxed{\mathbb{E}[X + Y] = \frac{5}{4}}.$$

Also,

$$\boxed{\mathbb{E}[XY] = \int_0^1 \int_0^1 xy \frac{3}{2}(x^2 + y^2) dx dy = \frac{3}{8}}.$$

(c) Again by symmetry,

$$\mathbb{E}[X^2] = \mathbb{E}[Y^2] = \int_0^1 x^2 \frac{1+3x^2}{2} dx = \frac{7}{15}.$$

Therefore,

$$\text{Var}(X) = \text{Var}(Y) = \frac{7}{15} - \left(\frac{5}{8}\right)^2 = \frac{73}{960},$$

and, by Theorem 4.4,

$$\text{Cov}(X, Y) = \frac{3}{8} - \left(\frac{5}{8}\right)^2 = -\frac{1}{64}.$$

Thus,

$$\boxed{\text{Var}(X) = \text{Var}(Y) = \frac{73}{960}, \quad \text{Cov}(X, Y) = -\frac{1}{64}}.$$

(d) Using the moments already found,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[(X + Y)^2] &= \mathbb{E}[X^2] + 2\mathbb{E}[XY] + \mathbb{E}[Y^2] = \frac{101}{60}, \\ \text{Var}(X + Y) &= \frac{101}{60} - \left(\frac{5}{4}\right)^2 = \boxed{\frac{29}{240}}. \end{aligned}$$

□